

Firearms Trace Data: Missouri - 2023

Data Source: Firearms Tracing System

January 1, 2023 – December 31, 2023

Contents

1. [ATF Firearms Trace Data Disclaimer](#)
2. Table: [Total Number of Firearms Recovered and Traced in Missouri in Calendar Year 2023](#)
3. Table: [Firearm Types with a Missouri Recovery](#)
4. Table: [Top Calibers Reported on Firearm Traces with a Missouri Recovery](#)
5. Table: [Top Categories Reported on Firearm Traces with a Missouri Recovery](#)
6. Table: [Top 15 Source States for Firearms with a Missouri Recovery](#)
7. Table: [Time-To-Crime Rates for Firearms with a Missouri Recovery](#)
8. Table: [Age of Possessors for Firearms with a Missouri Recovery](#)
9. Table: [Top Recovery Cities for Firearms with a Missouri Recovery](#)
10. [Analytical Criteria Used to Compile the Enclosed Statistics](#)

ATF Firearms Trace Data Disclaimer

Firearm traces are designed to assist law enforcement authorities in conducting investigations by tracking the sale and possession of specific firearms. Law enforcement agencies may request firearms traces for any investigative reason, and those reasons are not necessarily reported to the federal government. Not all firearms used in crime are traced and not all firearms traced are used in crime.

Firearms selected for tracing are not chosen for purposes of determining which types, makes or models of firearms are used for illicit purposes. The firearms selected do not constitute a random sample and should not be considered representative of the larger universe of all firearms used by criminals, or any subset of that universe. Firearms are normally traced to the first retail seller, and sources reported for firearms traced do not necessarily represent the sources or methods by which firearms in general are acquired for use in crime.

Total Number of Firearms Recovered and Traced in Missouri in Calendar Year 2023

10,838

Firearm Types with a Missouri Recovery

January 1, 2023 – December 31, 2023

Pistols	8,659
Rifles	753
Revolvers	556
Shotguns	347
Machinegun Conversion Devices	300
Receivers/Frames	83
Other*	140

* Other includes Machineguns, Derringers, Unknown Types, Silencers and Combinations.

Top Calibers Reported on Firearm Traces with a Missouri Recovery

January 1, 2023 – December 31, 2023

9mm	4,728
.40 Cal	1,261
.45 Cal	664
.380 Cal	616
.22 Cal	559

5.56mm	283
.223 Cal	276
12GA	268
7.62mm	264
.38 Cal	258

NOTE: There were 1,203 additional traces that were associated with other calibers. There were 458 traces with an unknown caliber.

Top Categories Reported on Firearm Traces with a Missouri Recovery

January 1, 2023 – December 31, 2023

Possession of Weapon	2,109
Firearm Under Investigation	1,875
Weapon Offense	1,174
Found Firearm	936
Property Crimes	775
Dangerous Drugs	658
Aggravated Assault	496
Homicide	470
Simple Assault	316
Family Offense	292
Health - Safety	285

NOTE: There were 1,452 additional traces that were associated with other categories.

Top 15 Source States for Firearms with a Missouri Recovery

January 1, 2023 – December 31, 2023

Missouri	7,360
Kansas	518
Illinois	217
Texas	142
Arkansas	90
Florida	60
Oklahoma	55
Tennessee	49
Georgia	45
Arizona	39
Kentucky	39
Colorado	35
Indiana	34
Ohio	34
Mississippi	30

NOTE: An additional 34 states, Guam and Puerto Rico accounted for 352 other traces. The source state was identified in 9,099 total traces.

Time-To-Crime Rates for Firearms with a Missouri Recovery

January 1, 2023 – December 31, 2023

Under 3 Months	671
3 Months to Under 7 Months	630
7 Months to Under 1 Year	728
1 Year to Under 2 Years	1,534
2 Years to Under 3 Years	1,220
3 Years and Over	4,285

1/1/2023-12/31/2023 Missouri Average Time-to-Crime: **5.31 Years**

1/1/2023-12/31/2023 National Average Time-to-Crime: **6.76 Years**

Age of Possessors for Firearms with a Missouri Recovery

January 1, 2023 – December 31, 2023

17 and Under	401
18 to 21	941
22 to 24	807
25 to 30	1,242
31 to 40	1,724
41 to 50	1,070
Over 50	823

1/1/2023-12/31/2023 Missouri Average Age of Possessor: **34 Years**

1/1/2023-12/31/2023 National Average Age of Possessor: **35 Years**

Top Recovery Cities for Firearms with a Missouri Recovery

January 1, 2023 – December 31, 2023

Saint Louis	3,392
Kansas City	2,590
Clayton	450
Independence	445
Florissant	387
Springfield	386
Saint Charles	266
Columbia	185
Bridgeton	158
Maryland Heights	118

NOTE: There were 254 additional municipalities that accounted for 2,372 other traces. The recovery city could not be determined for 89 traces.

Analytical Criteria Used to Compile the Enclosed Statistics

Total Number of Firearms Recovered and Traced

- Includes traces with a recovery state of Missouri. Traces in which the recovery state was not provided were included when the requesting agency state was equal to Missouri.
- Includes Firearms Recovered and Traced between 1/1/2023 –12/31/2023 or, if the recovery date was blank, firearms with trace entry dates between 1/1/2023 –12/31/2023.

- Duplicate traces, Firearms Not Recovered, Gun Buyback and Firearms Turned In are not included in this figure.
- Data was extracted from the Firearms Tracing System (FTS) on April 10, 2024.
- All traces may not have been submitted or completed at the time of this study.

Firearm Types and Calibers with a Missouri Recovery

- Includes same criteria as Total Number of Firearms Recovered and Traced.

Top Categories Reported on Firearm Traces with a Missouri Recovery

- Includes same criteria as Total Number of Firearms Recovered and Traced.

Top Source States for Firearms with a Missouri Recovery

- Includes same criteria as Total Number of Firearms Recovered and Traced.
- Traces must identify a purchaser and the state in which the final dealer is located.

Time-to-Crime Rates for Firearms with a Missouri Recovery

- Includes same criteria as Total Number of Firearms Recovered and Traced.
- Traces must identify a purchaser.
- Time-to-Crime was calculated for those traces in which the purchase date could be subtracted from the recovery date.

Age of Possessors for Firearms with a Missouri Recovery

- Includes same criteria as Total Number of Firearms Recovered and Traced.
- Includes traces that provide a possessor and the possessor's date of birth.
- Possessor's age is calculated by subtracting the possessor's date of birth from the recovery date.

Top Recovery Cities for Firearms with a Missouri Recovery

- Includes same criteria as Total Number of Firearms Recovered and Traced.
- Includes traces with a recovery city or, if the recovery city was not provided, traces requested by agencies with jurisdiction only within that city.

[View All 2023 Firearms Trace Data](#)

Last updated: December 9, 2024